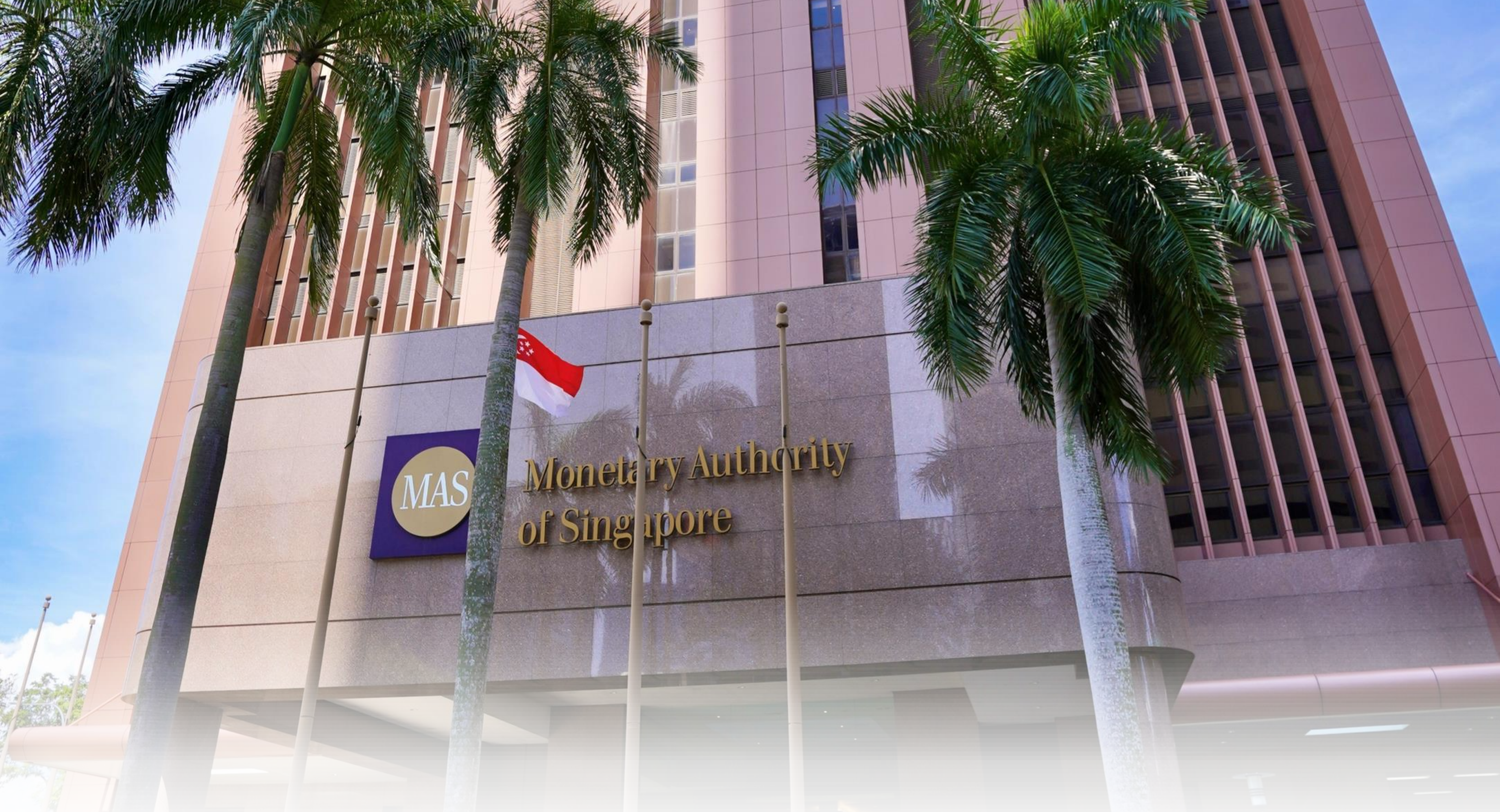

ENFORCEMENT REPORT

JULY 2023 TO DEC 2024

CONTENTS

OPENING MESSAGE

Peggy Pao-Keerthi Pei Yu
Executive Director
Enforcement Department

As Singapore's financial sector grows in size and complexity, the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS) has taken steps to ensure that our investigative and enforcement capabilities keep pace and remain effective. In this reporting period, we enhanced our investigative powers via the Financial Institutions (Miscellaneous Amendments) Bill, which strengthened our ability to gather evidence and share them with partner agencies. We also amended our powers to enable us to issue prohibition orders to a broader scope of persons, and prevent them from carrying out functions that are not regulated by MAS but are critical to the integrity of financial institutions. Collectively, these legislative amendments stand MAS in strong stead to continue taking robust action against serious misconduct across the financial sector.

Apart from updating our statutory powers, we continued to deepen our partnership with key agencies, such as the Attorney-General's Chambers (AGC), Commercial Affairs Department of the Singapore Police Force and the Accounting and Corporate Regulatory Authority. We also benefited immensely from learning about the best practices of international counterpart regulators in cutting-edge areas such as cryptocurrency-related surveillance and investigation, through overseas attachments and study exchanges.

Even as we strengthen our ability to tackle new or emerging types of misconduct, pursuing manipulative conduct in the securities markets remains one of our evergreen priorities. The increase from the previous report in average time taken for criminal cases reflected the conclusion of a significant number of such matters during this reporting period, including complex investigations involving multiple suspects, novel misconduct or the need for foreign assistance. Securing stiff penalties is also an important enforcement strategy to deter similar misconduct. Working with the AGC, we successfully obtained significant imprisonment terms in a case involving "pump and dump" on Telegram and a case involving fraudulent trading by a fund manager.

Another of our constant enforcement priorities is tackling financial services misconduct. This includes taking firm action against licensees who fail to comply with business conduct rules, and financial institutions and their staff who fail to comply with our anti-money laundering and countering the financing of terrorism (AML/CFT) requirements, which is a critical pillar of MAS' strategy for dealing with money laundering risks. We cancelled the registration of an insurance broker, imposed composition on two fund management companies and reprimanded their officers for non-compliance with such requirements. MAS also conducted supervisory reviews and inspections of financial institutions who had dealings with suspects in the $3 billion money laundering case, and will take enforcement action against those who have fallen short.

Firm and fair action against misconduct ensures trust in the financial system and is essential to building a dynamic and thriving financial centre. We will continue to enhance our capabilities and processes to meet the ever evolving challenges of enforcement in a dynamic financial sector.

01 MAS' ENFORCEMENT PRINCIPLES

Vision	Mission	Enforcement Approach

Vision

To safeguard Singapore as a trusted international financial centre, with sound financial institutions and efficient markets.

Mission

To administer an enforcement regime that delivers effective, fair and swift outcomes, in order to deter misconduct, protect consumers, and maintain investor confidence.

Our Approach

- Early detection of misconduct and breaches of law
- Effective deterrence
- Shaping business and market conduct

02 2023/2024 ACHIEVEMENTS

Enforcement Outcomes	Reviews and Investigations	Average Time Taken for MAS' Reviews and Investigations

ENFORCEMENT OUTCOMES

Actions taken on breaches of MAS-administered Acts, Regulations and Notices* for the Reporting Period of 1 July 2023 to 31 December 2024

33 Criminal Convictions#

Sentenced to imprisonment (19 individuals), imprisonment with fine/disgorgement of profits (1 individual) and fine only (13 individuals)

Convicted for false trading (12 individuals), deception/ fraud under Securities and Futures Act (5 individuals), disclosure-related breaches (9 individuals), breach of requirements for offer documents (1 individual) and unlicensed conduct of regulated activity (6 individuals)@

$7.16 million in Civil Penalties

Imposed for false trading (6 individuals), insider trading (1 individual) and deceptive practices (2 entities)

$4.4 million in Financial Penalties and Compositions

Against 2 capital markets services licensees for AML/CFT breaches

22 Prohibition Orders / 1 Cancellation of Registration

Unfit representatives banned from re-entering the financial industry for a duration of 1 to 5 years (15 individuals), 6 to 10 years (4 individuals), and more than 10 years (3 individual) / Registration of 1 insurance broker cancelled

542 Other Actions Taken

These comprised 35 reprimands, 116 warnings#, 86 letters of advice#, 305 supervisory reminders

** Includes cases where review/investigation concluded in the previous period but actions were taken in the current period. Refer to paragraph 6 of the Enforcement Monograph for details on the types of enforcement actions which MAS may pursue.*

 # Includes all cases under the MAS-CAD Joint Investigation Arrangement.

@ Only the primary offences in the cases are listed. These individuals could have been convicted for other offences as well.

REVIEWS AND INVESTIGATIONS

Reporting Period: 1 July 2023 to 31 December 2024

163 cases opened during the reporting period

Type of cases*	Number of cases
Insider trading**	41
False trading**	17
Deception / Fraud under the Securities and Futures Act**	5
Disclosure-related breaches**	19
Breach of requirements for offer documents**	3
Carrying on regulated activities without licence**	19
Mis-selling of financial products	0
Breach of business conduct rules	14
Prohibition Orders***	20
Money laundering-related control breaches	16
Others**	9

** Cases listed in the table may have sub-offences. The cases are categorised based on the primary offence that triggered the review or investigation.*
*** Includes all cases under the MAS-CAD Joint Investigation Arrangement.*
**** Previously listed as "Referral by other agencies for assessment of fitness & propriety"*

AVERAGE TIME TAKEN FOR MAS' REVIEWS AND INVESTIGATIONS

Reporting Period: 1 July 2023 to 31 December 2024

Average Time Taken*

Criminal Prosecutions	Civil Penalties	Other Actions	Referrals to External Agencies	Average Across All Concluded Cases
35 months	34 months	12 months	2 months	13 months

CLOSED

** Average time taken refers to the period between the date a case was opened for review and the date the case was closed. A case is considered closed when it is referred to AGC for criminal prosecution or civil action, approved for regulatory action or a decision is made to take no further action.*

03 KEY AREAS OF FOCUS

Market Abuse	Financial Services Misconduct	Money Laundering-Related Control Breaches	Implementation of New Investigation Powers

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Market Abuse

The main types of market abuse that MAS investigates include insider trading, false trading and disclosure-related breaches.

Why Tackle Market Abuse?

Market abuse undermines the integrity of Singapore's financial system, erodes public confidence in its capital markets and discourages market participation. Therefore, it is important that there is effective enforcement of the laws to protect investors and ensure a level playing field for all market participants.

Early Intervention through Surveillance

Effective surveillance enables early detection and disruption of potential market abuse. This complements robust investigation and enforcement in cases of serious misconduct. MAS' surveillance approach and initiatives are detailed in this section.

Deterrence through Stiff Punishments

A key pillar of our enforcement philosophy is deterrence. Imprisonment terms and significant civil penalties in the more serious market misconduct cases deter market abuse and shape conduct in our capital markets.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Market Abuse – Effective Surveillance

MAS' proactive surveillance enables early detection of and timely intervention in potential market abuse. MAS collaborates closely with key stakeholders, including brokers, SGX, CAD and ACRA, to pick up and address misconduct. Additionally, MAS monitors emerging trends and continually sharpens its surveillance techniques and intelligence gathering.

Intervening in Potential Market Abuse

Enhanced Disruption Framework
Timely trading restrictions on suspicious accounts exhibiting questionable trading behavior are an effective tool to nip potential market abuse in the bud. MAS worked with brokerages to share appropriate information about and promptly stop manipulative trading behaviour involving accounts across the brokerages.

Continued Engagement with Key Stakeholders
MAS, together with SGX RegCo, conducted a series of closed-door engagements with senior management of broker firms as well as market makers with a focus on identifying emerging risks and soliciting feedback to assist in our market surveillance. In addition, MAS continued its close collaboration with ACRA by sharing information on and referring appropriate accounting-related corporate disclosure cases to each other.

Leveraging on OSINT and Intelligence

Detecting Unlicensed Entities in Capital Markets
Internet and social media platforms offer easy channels for the offering and marketing of financial products. MAS used Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) and data analytics to detect firms that were carrying on regulated capital market activities without authorisation. These cases were promptly reviewed and escalated for investigation.

Building Intelligence Sources
MAS has multiple channels for gathering intelligence and information to help in early detection of breaches. Apart from Suspicious Transaction Report (STR) filings, information from members of public can also provide important intelligence for detecting misconduct. MAS continues to encourage submission of feedback and complaints from members of public.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Market Abuse – Featured Case

"Pump and Dump" Scheme on Telegram

"Pump and Dump" schemes via social media have potentially wide reach and can be challenging to investigate. The Singapore authorities have issued several warnings about trading based on advice in online platforms.

In this case, between 30 April and 23 November 2020, Mr Oon Yun Cong (Mr Oon) made false statements on 10 occasions in two Telegram chat groups to induce members in these chat groups to purchase shares in the securities held by him.

His false statements included overstating his target sell price for the securities and claiming that he had purchased shares in the securities when he had not. It is estimated that Oon made a profit of about $12,105.70.

Action Taken

Mr Oon was charged in court on 15 May 2024 and convicted on 9 October 2024 of two charges of making false statements to induce others to trade under section 200(1)(a) of the SFA. He was sentenced to 16 months' imprisonment and fined $12,105.70.

What was the "Pump and Dump" Scheme?

Mr Oon was an active contributor to the two Telegram chat groups with about 2,955 members, that discussed the Singapore stock market. Mr Oon shared his views regularly, particularly on spotting and predicting price rises in stocks. He managed to garner a following in the chat groups and was given the title of "Top Spotter" by the administrator in one of the chat groups.

Some time in 2020, Mr Oon conspired with his friend, one Kenneth Goh, a fellow member in the two chat groups, to devise a scheme in which they would jointly promote stocks that they had an interest in the chat groups. They would post false messages regarding their trades and shareholdings with the intent of inducing other members in the chat groups to also trade in those stocks. They would then sell their existing stakes in these stocks at a profit when the prices rose as a result of the increased trading activities.

Mr Kenneth Goh was charged and convicted for similar offences. He was sentenced to 19 months' imprisonment and fined $355,604 on 19 December 2022.

The two Telegram chat groups were titled "SGX Penny Stocks Discussion" and "Trade with the Wind".

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Market Abuse – Featured Case

KTL Global Limited* Former CEO Convicted for False Trading

Mr Tan Kheng Yeow (Mr Tan), the former CEO and executive director of KTL Global Limited (KTL Global) conspired with another person, Mr Tang Boon Hai (Mr Tang) to create a false appearance of active trading in KTL Global shares. The duo intended for such false appearance to induce genuine market participants to buy KTL Global shares, thereby increasing their share price.

This was amid concerns that KTL Global was unable to meet the minimum trading price (MTP)# requirement imposed by the Singapore Exchange. Mr Tan also knew that his net worth would increase accordingly if the price of KTL Global shares increased, as he held significant quantities of KTL Global shares.

Action Taken

Mr Tan was convicted and sentenced to 8 months' imprisonment for the false trading charge. He is currently facing other charges under the Penal Code.

Mr Tang was convicted and sentenced to a global imprisonment term of 30 months, which includes his sentences for other related offences.

How was the Scheme Executed?

First, Mr Tang procured the use of 14 trading accounts registered under the names of five other persons to further the false trading scheme.

Second, Mr Tan arranged for a total of $500,000 to be deposited into 2 of the 14 trading accounts on 6 November 2014 to fund the false trading scheme. These monies originated from KTL Offshore, a subsidiary of KTL Global.

From 4 November 2014 to 8 September 2015, Mr Tang used the 14 trading accounts to buy and sell approximately 122.76 million and 120.67 million KTL Global shares respectively, of which, more than 70 million shares were bought and sold between these trading accounts.

As a result of Mr Tang's trades, KTL Global's share price increased from a low of $0.115 on 4 November 2014 to a high of $0.191 on 25 May 2015, before closing at $0.118 on 8 September 2015. This was amid failing global oil prices and dampened performance of the oil and gas industry.

* KTL Global was in the business of supplying wire rope, rigging and heavy lift products and services for the offshore oil & gas and related industries.

SGX announced the MTP requirement for Mainboard-listed issuers on 1 August 2014. The requirement, which was implemented in March 2015, meant that an issuer's volume weighted average price (VWAP) over a six-month period could not fall below 20 cents. Any issuer that failed to comply with the MTP faced the possibility of delisting. The MTP requirement was removed with effect from 1 June 2020.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Financial Services Misconduct

The main types of financial services misconduct that MAS investigates include mis-selling of financial products, breaches of business conduct rules and serious unfitness and impropriety.

Why Tackle Financial Services Misconduct?

Financial services firms and their representatives provide vital services to the public. Ensuring their fitness and propriety as well as compliance with business conduct rules are integral to upholding the quality of and public confidence in the financial services industry.

Focus on Asset and Wealth Managers

As Singapore continues to position itself as a leading asset and wealth management hub, MAS has been focusing on ensuring the integrity of these sectors. MAS has and will continue to take robust action against errant players who have breached applicable laws and regulations, including business conduct and AML/CFT requirements. Key enforcement actions are detailed in this section.

Enhancement of Powers

MAS' powers to issue Prohibition Orders (POs) have been expanded under the Financial Services and Markets Act (FSMA). MAS is now able to issue a PO to any person who is not fit and proper to perform key roles, activities and functions across the financial sector. MAS' expanded investigative powers under the Financial Institutions (Miscellaneous Amendments) Bill 2024 will also strengthen MAS' ability to address cases of serious misconduct in the financial sector through harmonised powers to obtain information through interviews, production orders or seizure across various MAS-administered Acts.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Financial Services Misconduct – Featured Case

Former Fund Manager Convicted for Fraudulent Conduct

Mr Sun Weiyeh (Mr Sun), a former fund manager, and director of One Asia Investment Partners (OAIP) was convicted on 11 April 2024 of two counts under section 201(b) of the Securities and Futures Act (SFA) for engaging in acts which were likely to defraud investors of a fund managed by OAIP (Fund A).

He had sold two OTC bonds at lower prices from Fund A to another OAIP fund (Fund B) of which he was the majority investor, while knowing that there were earlier available bids at higher prices. Mr Sun subsequently sold the two bonds to the market at a profit. Mr Sun's act caused a US$342,500 loss to investors in Fund A.

What was the Misconduct?

Mr Sun carried out his misconduct by first soliciting bids from various market participants via the Bloomberg chat messaging system.

He then used lower bid prices as the reference prices to sell the two OTC bonds from Fund A to Fund B through an intermediary, instead of selling the bonds to a market participant who had offered higher prices or using those higher bid prices as the reference prices to sell to Fund B.

Action Taken

Following a 26-day trial, Mr Sun was convicted and sentenced to 6 months' imprisonment for fraudulent or deceptive conduct relating to over-the-counter (OTC) bond trading.

Mr Sun has filed a Notice of Appeal against his conviction.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Financial Services Misconduct – Featured Case

14-year Prohibition Order Issued Against Former Representative of United Overseas Bank (UOB)

MAS banned former personal banker, Mr Loh Sheng Yang (Mr Loh), from:

- providing financial advisory services and performing regulated activity, and
- from taking part in the management, acting as director or becoming a substantial shareholder of any financial advisory firm or capital markets services firm under the Financial Advisers Act 2001 and the Securities and Futures Act 2001.

Mr Loh was convicted of multiple offences involving dishonesty such as cheating and forgery offences under the Penal Code, and an offence of using the benefits of his criminal conduct under the Corruption, Drug Trafficking and Other Serious Crimes (Confiscation of Benefits) Act. He was sentenced to 68 months' imprisonment.

MAS thus had reasons to believe that Mr Loh would not perform financial advisory services and carry out regulated activities honestly. The 14-year Prohibition Order took effect from 26 November 2024.

What was the Dishonest Conduct?

Between 10 June 2021 and 6 February 2023, Mr Loh defrauded a total of 17 victims of more than $1 million.

Mr Loh induced the victims to sign up for fictitious UOB fixed and structured deposit products. He also gave forged documents to some victims to convince them that their monies had been deposited with the bank.

Mr Loh subsequently used the monies obtained from the victims for his online gambling activities.

Mr Loh first started committing the offences while he was employed as a representative for UOB, and continued even after he was suspended by UOB and while he was under investigation by the Singapore Police Force.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Money Laundering-Related Control Breaches

MAS expects financial institutions (FIs) to have robust Anti-Money Laundering and Countering the Financing of Terrorism (AML/CFT) controls to detect and disrupt attempts to abuse Singapore's financial system for illicit purposes.

Why Tackle Money Laundering-Related Control Breaches?

Singapore, a dynamic and trusted financial centre, is exposed to the risk of being used as a conduit for money laundering and terrorist financing activities. MAS works closely with partners such as the Commercial Affairs Department to uncover and address money laundering and related control breaches.

Robust Supervision & Enforcement

MAS' risk-focused supervisory approach is supported by surveillance and data-driven insights. MAS will take firm and appropriate enforcement actions against FIs found to have breached AML/CFT requirements. Key enforcement actions are detailed in this section.

Enhanced Focus on Accountability

MAS expects the board of directors and senior managers to exercise strong oversight over ML/TF risks, as well as ensure the effective implementation of key AML/CFT controls. MAS has and will continue to take firm action against senior managers who do not properly discharge their duties.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Money Laundering-Related Control Breaches

FEATURED CASES — Actions Against Fund Management Companies

Swiss-Asia Financial Services Pte. Ltd. (SAFS)

MAS imposed a composition penalty of S$2.5m on SAFS. SAFS' CEO, Mr Oliver Pascal Mivelaz and its COO, Mr Steve Knabl were reprimanded for failing to ensure that SAFS complied with MAS' AML/CFT requirements.

SAFS experienced significant business growth but its AML/CFT controls did not keep pace with the growth and were inadequate. This resulted in multiple breaches of MAS' AML/CFT requirements and exposed SAFS to the risk of financial crime.

What were the Breaches?

- Failure to adequately establish the source of wealth and/or the source of funds of customers the company identified to be of higher ML/TF risk and their beneficial owners
- Failure to submit suspicious transaction reports in relation to several customers even though there was sufficient basis to do so
- Failure to conduct any internal audit to monitor the effectiveness of the company's AML/CFT controls and its compliance with regulatory requirements

Atrium Asia Investment Management Pte. Ltd. (AAIM)

MAS imposed a composition penalty of S$1.9m on AAIM. AAIM's CEO, Mr Mintarja Oei, was reprimanded for failing to ensure that AAIM complied with MAS' AML/CFT requirements.

MAS' inspection of AAIM found that the Company's internal AML/CFT policy and procedures at the material time were inadequate. This led to multiple breaches of MAS' AML/CFT requirements from June 2015 to October 2020, putting the firm at risk of being misused for financial crime.

What were the Breaches?

- Failure to implement adequate processes to detect and report suspicious and unusually large customer transactions with third parties
- Failure to implement appropriate internal risk management systems and procedures to determine if customers and related persons were politically exposed persons (PEPs) or close associates of PEPs. As a result, AAIM did not identify several customers to be PEPs.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Implementing New Powers to Issue Prohibition Orders

Legislation to harmonise and expand MAS' powers to issue prohibition orders ("**POs**") under part 3 of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2022 ("**FSMA**") came into force on 31 July 2024.

Key Features

The new PO regime:

Broadened scope of persons who can be issued with a PO to "any person"

Rationalised the grounds for issuing prohibition orders from a list of specific criteria to a single fit and proper test. MAS will assess whether a person is fit and proper based on factors relating to a person's (a) honesty, integrity and reputation; (b) competence and capability; and (c) financial soundness.

Expanded scope of prohibition to cover functions that are critical to the integrity and functioning of financial institutions: (a) handling of funds or assets, (b) risk taking, (c) risk management and control and (d) critical system administration.

Safeguards

The FSMA PO power will be exercised judiciously and proportionately, and will only be applied against persons with a former, existing or prospective nexus to the financial industry.

The industry can expect a large degree of continuity in the way MAS exercises its power. MAS will continue its practice of exercising this power only in cases of serious misconduct.

As with the previous PO powers, persons are informed of MAS' intention to issue POs against them and have the opportunity to make representations. Individuals issued POs also have a right to appeal to the Minister.

KEY AREA OF FOCUS
Enhanced Investigation Powers Across MAS Acts

Legislation to strengthen or widen existing investigative powers, and standardise MAS' investigation powers across MAS-administered Acts* under the Financial Institutions (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2024 came into force on 24 January 2025.

Key Features

MAS has the following powers under the MAS-administered Acts:

- Compel individuals to attend interviews.
- Obtain information from any person.
- Enter premises without a warrant, subject to conditions.
- Obtain a warrant to seize information.
- Transfer to the Police and/or Public Prosecutor evidence gathered for criminal investigations or proceedings for offences under the MAS-administered Acts.
- Use evidence obtained by other law enforcement agencies for MAS' investigations, regulatory actions, and consequent appeals.

Need for Enhanced Investigative Powers

These enhanced investigative powers are necessary to:

- Ensure that MAS can effectively and efficiently pursue offences under the Acts that it administers.
- Prevent duplication of investigations between MAS and other law enforcement agencies.

Safeguards

MAS will exercise its enhanced investigation powers judiciously and proportionately. Safeguards have also been built into legislation such as the requirement for MAS to give two days' notice before entering premises without a warrant, unless specific conditions are fulfilled.

** "MAS-administered Acts" refer to the Securities and Futures Act 2001, Financial Advisers Act 2001, Financial Services and Markets Act 2022, Insurance Act 1966, Payment Services Act 2019 and Trust Companies Act 2005.*

04 MAJOR ONGOING CASES

The list of major ongoing cases in this section is non-exhaustive. In deciding whether and when to release information about ongoing investigations, MAS balances the public's interest in obtaining information against the need to protect the integrity of investigations and any pending court proceedings.

MAJOR ONGOING CASES
Progress Update

Eagle Hospitality Trust

On 5 June 2020, MAS and CAD launched a joint investigation into Eagle Hospitality Trust (EHT) for possible offences under the SFA.

The investigation stemmed from a referral by Singapore Exchange Regulation (SGX RegCo). This followed a review that was announced by MAS and SGX RegCo on 20 April 2020 into possible breaches of relevant laws and regulations as well as exchange listing rules.

Status Update

MAS charged the former CEO of EHT REIT Manager on 17 May 2024 for disclosure-related offences. Court proceedings are ongoing.

Investigations against the other directors are currently ongoing.

Samtrade FX Limited

On 28 December 2021, MAS and CAD launched a joint investigation into Samtrade FX Limited (Samtrade) and its related entities for potential offences under section 82 of the SFA, which prohibits any person from carrying on a business in any regulated activity without a capital markets services licence.

Samtrade and its related entities are not licensed by MAS, and have been placed on MAS' Investor Alert List since July 2021.

Status Update

MAS has completed investigations against individuals who were engaged by Samtrade to conduct fund management activities on behalf of its clients.

MAS is currently working with AGC to review the findings.

Singapore's $3b Money Laundering Case

On 15 August 2023, the Singapore Police Force commenced investigations into a $3 billion money laundering case. 10 foreign nationals were arrested and subsequently convicted.

MAS conducted supervisory reviews of financial institutions who had business relations (such as account opening and maintenance) with persons involved in the money laundering.

Status Update

MAS is in the process of reviewing AML/CFT breaches by FIs and their key staff.

MAS will ensure fair and proportionate enforcement actions for serious breaches.

05 INTERNATIONAL COOPERATION

MAS collaborates closely with international regulators and enforcement agencies to combat cross-border misconduct.

INTERNATIONAL COOPERATION

International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO)

MAS is a signatory to both the IOSCO's Multilateral Memorandum of Understanding (MMoU) and Enhanced MMoU (EMMoU) and has used both extensively to obtain information from, and render assistance to, fellow signatory regulators for the purpose of enforcing and securing compliance with securities and derivatives laws in the requesting regulator's jurisdiction.

MAS is also a Member of IOSCO Committee 4 on Enforcement and the Exchange of Information and is involved in efforts to enhance and facilitate global enforcement cooperation between IOSCO members through the formulation of policy.

How is MAS involved?

MAS is committed to rendering assistance, to the extent legally permissible, to our foreign counterparts under the IOSCO MMoU and EMMoU.

MAS had provided assistance to fellow signatory regulators for their investigations, including into potential breaches of their securities and derivatives-related regulations. For example:

- MAS rendered assistance to the United States Securities and Exchange Commission in connection with their investigation into a romance investment scam involving the fake crypto asset trading platform, CoinW6.
- MAS also rendered assistance to the Hong Kong Securities and Futures Commission in their investigations into a ramp-and-dump scheme involving the shares of Wan Cheng Metal Packaging Company Limited; false trading in the shares of Ching Lee Holdings Limited; and Listing Rule breaches in respect of the listing of Global Uin Intelligence Holdings Limited on the HKEX.

These investigations by our foreign counterparts resulted in successful enforcement actions, including criminal prosecution.

MAS rendered assistance in

92 IOSCO requests

from 24 international regulators and

sent 11 IOSCO requests

to 8 international regulators

06 LOOKING AHEAD

Enforcing AML/CFT Controls

Building Enforcement Capabilities in the Digital Asset Ecosystem

LOOKING AHEAD

In addition to our evergreen priorities, MAS will focus on:

Enforcing AML/CFT Controls

Singapore's AML framework is underpinned by a three-pronged strategy – Prevent, Detect and Enforce:

1. First, strengthening our legal and regulatory framework to **prevent** criminals from operating in Singapore;
2. Second, developing measures to better **detect** signs of illicit activity; and
3. Third, taking decisive administrative, regulatory and criminal measures to **enforce** our laws.

Money laundering is a persistent and evolving challenge to all international financial centres. MAS will continue to focus on taking robust action where FIs have failed to comply with AML/CFT requirements.

At the same time, MAS will continue to provide comprehensive guidance on AML/CFT practices to our FIs, deepen channels for data sharing amongst and with financial institutions, and review penalty frameworks to ensure that they remain proportionate and dissuasive.

Building Enforcement Capabilities in the Digital Asset Ecosystem

As the digital asset landscape continues to evolve, MAS has and will put in place regulations (including in the Payment Services Act and the Financial Services and Markets Act) to address key ML/TF risks, technology risks and risks to consumers.

MAS has engaged with overseas regulators on best practices for detecting and investigating digital asset-related misconduct. MAS has also engaged with industry players to deepen our understanding of common misconduct, and technology providers to enhance our investigative capabilities.